HENRI MATISSE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences. Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Henri Matisse was born in the north of France in 1869. He was training to be a lawyer when he fell ill, and his mother brought him a box of paints to pass the time. He never went back to law. In 1905 Matisse and his friends showed paintings with colours so bright and unreal, a green stripe down a face, a red sky, that a critic called them "les fauves", the wild beasts. The name stuck: their style is called Fauvism. Matisse painted The Dance, a ring of five figures holding hands against a blue and green background. When he was over seventy and too ill to stand at an easel, he found a new way to work: he cut shapes from paper his assistants had painted and pinned them to the wall. He called it drawing with scissors. The Snail, a spiral of coloured paper squares, is one of these cut-outs.

1. How did Matisse first start painting?

2. What does "les fauves" mean, and why did a critic use the words?

3. Describe the painting The Dance.

4. Why did Matisse begin making cut-outs, and what did he call this way of working?

5. What is The Snail made of?

YOUR TURN

Draw with scissors like Matisse: cut four or five bold shapes from coloured paper (leaves, stars, waves), arrange them in this box until they feel balanced, then glue them down. Draw a plan first if you have no paper.

HENRI MATISSE ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

MEET THE ARTIST

1. He fell ill while training to be a lawyer and his mother brought him a box of paints.
2. The wild beasts; because the colours in the paintings were so bright and unreal.
3. A ring of five figures holding hands against a blue and green background.
4. He was over seventy and too ill to stand at an easel; he called it drawing with scissors.
5. A spiral of coloured paper squares (cut-outs).

YOUR TURN

Drawing task; no single answer.

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